



YOU ARE **3 WEEKS AND 4 DAYS**

255 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

To embed itself in the lining of the uterus, the embryo-to-be needs the help of progesterone, secreted after ovulation by the empty egg follicle, the corpus luteum (shown in pink in this cross section of an ovary). Progesterone helps the lining thicken.

“Do you feel different? You’ll find yourself analyzing every twinge in your body as you look for signs that you’re pregnant.”

It’s still very early and you’re unlikely to have pregnancy symptoms yet—although you may have some [light spotting](#). Some women claim to “feel” pregnant, even before changes to their breasts are noticeable or before they start feeling sick. Some women say that they just “know.” You may be very in tune with your body and may notice that your body is changing even before you are able to take a test. Unfortunately, sometimes our minds can play tricks on us: you may want to be pregnant so much that you can sometimes convince yourself that you’re feeling different. If you don’t feel any different, don’t worry, this is also completely normal.

Either way the only definitive way to know whether or not you are pregnant is to take a pregnancy test (see [How to use a home pregnancy test](#)). You don’t need to go to your doctor to confirm your pregnancy. If the test is positive, you’re pregnant!

DIET BAN

Don’t diet! Restricting your food intake during pregnancy may mean your unborn baby misses out on valuable nutrients and increases risk of complications.

The doctor will weigh you and measure your height at your first visit to calculate your BMI and give you dietary advice if necessary. Eat normally and do not eat for two. Sensible weight gain in pregnancy will reduce the risk of gestational diabetes and preeclampsia.

If you are already on a restricted diet due to advice from a health professional, seek advice on how to adapt your diet for pregnancy. If you have been following food trends that limit eating particular foods or food groups, such as clean eating, dairy-free, or gluten-free (see below), seek advice to make sure your diet is not lacking in essential nutrients.

ASK A NUTRITIONIST

Can I eat a gluten-free diet during pregnancy? If you have celiac disease, it’s important to keep your diet gluten-free in pregnancy to reduce your risk of complications. Or you may use gluten-free foods if you are intolerant of gluten. In either case, additional calcium, iron, and vitamin B12